Universität St.Gallen

Institut für Computer Science
in Vorarlberg

Using the HSG Beamer template

A 10-minute tour with examples

HSG Beamer Theme Team
University of St. Gallen

From insight to impact

Agenda

1. Setup: assets, compiler, three commands
2. Helpers: every macro with one example
3. Sidebar: declaring the deck outline
4. Tips: traps, golden rules, where to look

Three commands to a finished deck

1. Copy `beamerthemeHSG.sty` and every `hsg-*` asset into your working directory.
2. Write your `deck.tex` starting from the skeleton in `templates/skeleton.tex`.
3. Compile three times:

```
pdflatex deck.tex
pdflatex deck.tex
pdflatex deck.tex
```

Three passes are needed because TikZ `remember picture` overlays settle on the second-and-third pass.

Preamble: what to set once, in this order

```latex
\documentclass[aspectratio=169]{beamer}
\usetheme{HSG}

\title{My talk}
\subtitle{Optional second line}
\author{Prof. Dr. Author Name}
\institute{Your Institute\\University of St.\,Gallen}
\date{}
\coursefooter{Course or project}
\coverimage{cover-photo.jpg}      % optional hero image

\hsgclosingcontact
  {Prof. Dr. Author Name}
  {author@unisg.ch}

\hsgsetsections{Intro, Methods, Results, Outlook}
```

The cover slide

Just one line in your document body:

```
\begin{frame}[plain]\titlepage\end{frame}
```

The cover photo comes from `\coverimage{...}` in the preamble. The HSG green badge frame is layered behind it.

Tip: the cover photo right edge clips with a slanted polygon. Pick a photo whose subject sits in the LEFT third so the clip does not crop it.

Agenda — numbered list with concrete-texture column

```latex
\hsgagenda{
  \item Introduction
  \item Methodology
  \item Results
  \item Discussion
  \item Conclusion
}
```

Use 4–6 items, one or two words each. The same items should appear in `\hsgsetsections` so the sidebar progress matches.

Section advance *(silent, no slide rendered)*

```
\hsgsection{Methods}  % advances the sidebar; renders no frame.
\begin{frame}
\frametitle{Sub-topic}
...
\end{frame}
```

Call `\hsgsection{Name}` right before the first content slide of each section. The vertical green progress bar on the left fills proportionally.

Standard content slide

```
\begin{frame}
\frametitle{Results}
\framesubtitle{Detection performance}
\begin{itemize}
\item \hsgemph{AUC = 0.89} on the held-out split
\item False-positive rate held at 2%
\end{itemize}
\end{frame}
```

`\framesubtitle` renders as a tiny grey breadcrumb above the title. Keep it under 6 words.

Two-column comparison — native Beamer `columns`

```
\begin{columns}[T]
\column{0.5\textwidth}
\textbf{Symmetric}
\begin{itemize}\item Shared key\item Fast\end{itemize}
\column{0.5\textwidth}
\textbf{Asymmetric}
\begin{itemize}\item Key pair\item Slow\end{itemize}
\end{columns}
```

No HSG-specific helper needed; Beamer's own `columns` environment is the right tool.

Statement — one big bold sentence

```
\hsgstatement{Security is a process, not a product.}
```

Renders at 36 pt HSG green bold on its own slide, with the standard footer chrome (logo + page number badge). Use sparingly — the whole deck should not feel like a billboard.

Security is a process, not a product.

Quote slides — two flavours

Black-on-white:

```
\hsgquote{The cloud is just somebody else's computer.}{Anonymous}
```

White-on-green:

```
\hsgquoteinverted{The best way to predict the future is to invent it.}{Alan
    Kay}
```

"

The cloud is just somebody else's computer.

Anonymous

Full-bleed image

```
\hsgfullimage{path/to/photo.jpg}
```

Image fills the whole 16×9 canvas. Pre-crop to 16:9 to avoid axis-aligned letterboxing. A small HSG logo overlays the bottom-left.

Declaring the deck outline

```latex
% In the preamble:
\hsgsetsections{Intro, Methods, Results, Outlook}

% In the document body, one call per section transition:
\hsgsection{Intro}          % section 1 starts here
... slides ...
\hsgsection{Methods}        % section 2 starts here
... slides ...
```

The narrow vertical bar on the left of every content slide fills green up to the current section. Past sections appear filled, the current section has a small ring marker, future sections are empty.

Closing slide

```latex
% In the preamble:
\hsgclosingcontact
  {Prof. Dr. Author Name}
  {author@unisg.ch}

% Last line of the document body:
\hsgclosing
```

`\hsgclosing` produces the full-bleed-campus-photo *Questions?* slide, with the translucent contact box, the HSG logo, the EQUIS/AACSB/AMBA accreditation strip, and the *From insight to impact* tagline. Override the headline with `\hsgclosingtext{Thank you.}` or the photo with `\hsgclosingphoto{...}`.

Golden rules

- **Never use HSG green for titles or headings.** It's reserved for the sidebar, the page badge, and inline `\hsgemph{...}`.
- **Three passes** of `pdflatex`. Two is not enough; remember-picture overlays drift on pass two.
- **Copy ALL assets** listed in the theme header. A missing `hsg-closing-logo-band.png` silently breaks the closing slide.
- **Keep slides spare.** If you find yourself shrinking to fit, split the slide instead.
- **Cover and closing** are hand-tuned. Do not redefine their templates.

Where to look when something breaks

Symptom	Where to look first
Title slide chrome misplaced	Compile two more times. Remember-picture needs three passes.
Logo or photo missing	One of `hsg-*.png`/`hsg-*.pdf`/`hsg-*.jpg` not copied next to the `.tex`.
Body bullets render green	You added a `\setbeamercolor` in your preamble. Remove it.
Sidebar progress empty	You didn't call `\hsgsetsections` in the preamble.
Page number clipped in badge	Three-digit numbers fit; four-digit do not. Split your deck.

Further reading inside this repo

- `AGENTS.md` — exhaustive agent-friendly reference.
- `templates/skeleton.tex` — minimal compileable starter.
- `templates/skeleton-content.tex` — one example of every helper.
- `example.tex` (this folder's parent) — the ready-to-render demo deck.
- `OVERLEAF.md` — how to upload the template to Overleaf and pick a compiler.

Issues, suggestions, fixes welcome at
github.com/brunobastosrodrigues/beamer-hsg.

Questions?

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